

Certyfikat PMP: Project Scope

Initiation, Selection, and the Genesis of
Project Authorization

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The definition of a successful project is one where the stakeholders are satisfied.



PHASE 1: ACTIVE



STAKEHOLDER ALIGNMENT: IN PROGRESS

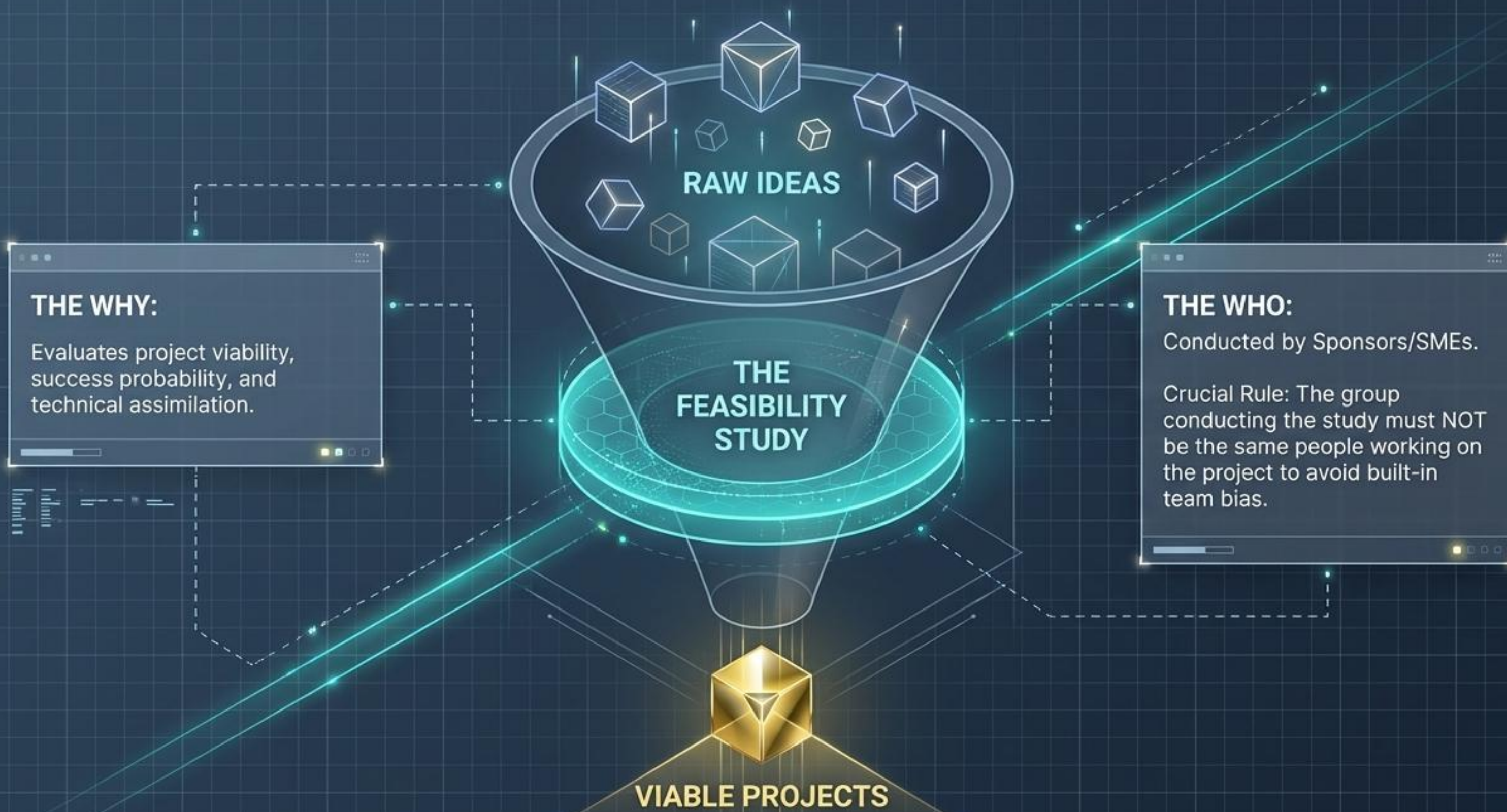


PROJECT INITIATION OVERVIEW

Initiation is the formal recognition that a project should begin. It is where needs, expectations, and scope boundaries are first recognized to ensure ultimate satisfaction.

THE CATALYSTS: 7 NEEDS & DEMANDS





THE PROJECT SELECTION DIVIDE

MATHEMATICAL MODELS

Constrained Optimization Methods



- **Mechanics:** Linear, dynamic, integer, nonlinear, and multi-objective programming.



- **Complexity:** Requires statistical/engineering backgrounds; relies on complex algorithms.

BENEFIT MEASUREMENT METHODS

Decision Models



- **Mechanics:** Comparative approaches, economic models, scoring models.



- **Focus:** The vast majority of PMP project selection techniques fall into this category.

**PMP
EXAM
FOCUS**

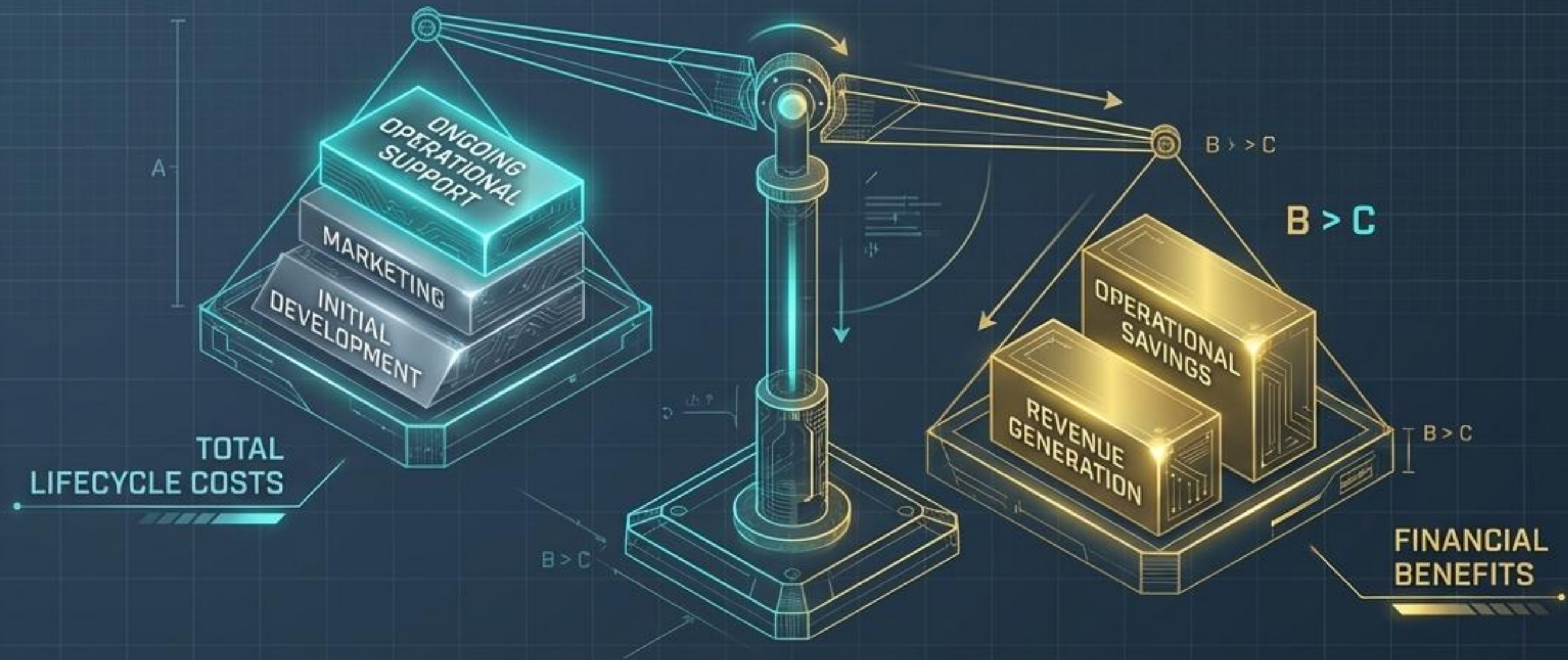
BENEFIT MEASUREMENT: SCORING MODELS

SCORING DASHBOARD

Criteria	Weight	Project A Score	Project A Total	Project B Score	Project B Total
Profit potential	5	5	25	5	25
Marketability	3	4	12	3	9
Ease to produce	1	4	4	3	3
Weighted Score	—	—	🏆 41 (WINNER)	—	37

Weighted Scoring Models allow strategic importance to dictate the math. Heavier weights ensure alignment with corporate goals.

BENEFIT MEASUREMENT: COST-BENEFIT ANALYSIS (CBA)



The **Golden Rule** of CBA: Financial benefits must outweigh the **total lifecycle costs**. A common failure point is ignoring the **ongoing operational support costs** once the product goes to market.

THE CORE CONCEPT: TIME VALUE OF MONEY

Money received in the future is worth less than money received today due to lost investment potential.

Today



Year 3

Future Value (FV)

$$FV = PV(1 + i)^n$$

Present Value (PV)

$$PV = \frac{FV}{(1 + i)^n}$$

Example: \$2,315 received in three years is only worth \$2,000 today (at a 5% interest rate).

Cash Flow Evaluation Matrix

Technique	Definition	Precision Level	Time Value Considered?	Selection Rule
Payback Period	Time to recoup initial investment	Lowest	No	Shorter is better
Discounted Cash Flows (DCF)	Compares future cash flows to today's dollars	Medium	Yes	Highest total wins
Net Present Value (NPV)	Evaluates cash inflows using DCF, minus initial investment	High (Conservative)	Yes	Accept if > 0
Internal Rate of Return (IRR)	The discount rate when NPV equals 0	High (Complex)	Yes	Highest percentage wins

EXECUTIVE DECISION DASHBOARD (NPV & IRR)

NET PRESENT VALUE (NPV)



- **Rule:** $NPV > 0 = \text{ACCEPT}$.
 $NPV < 0 = \text{REJECT}$.
- **Nuance:** Projects with high returns early in the lifecycle are superior.

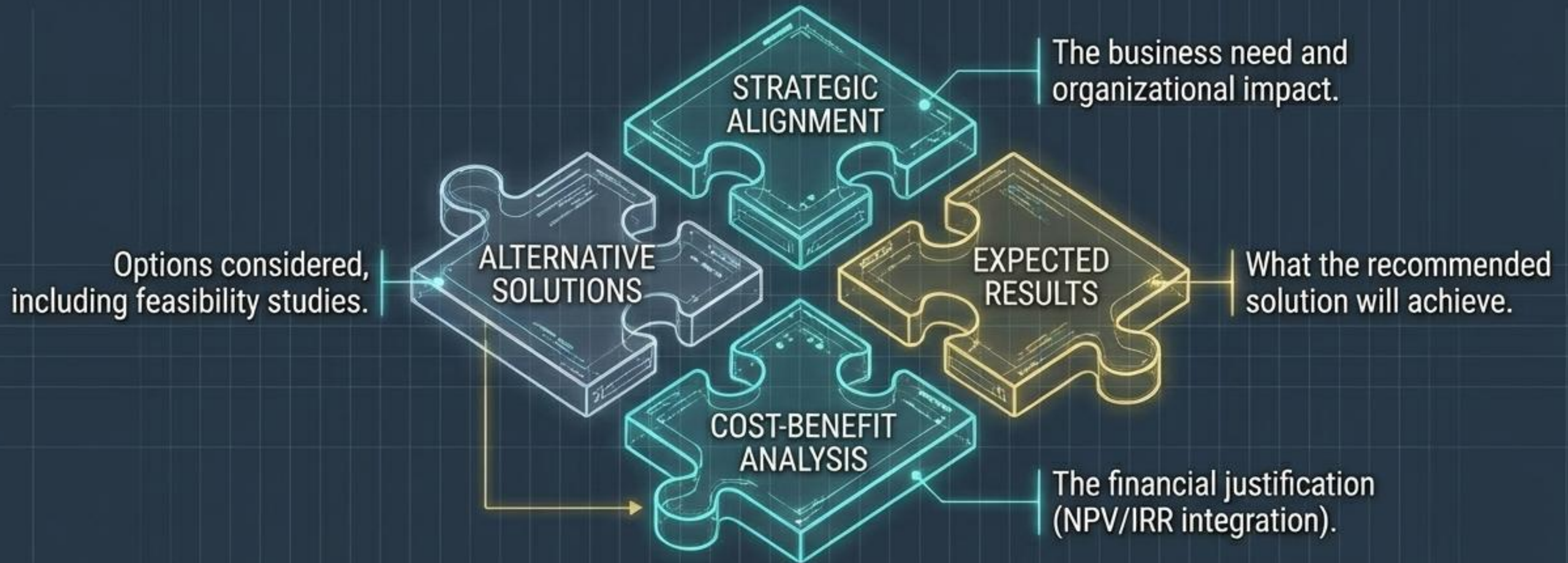
INTERNAL RATE OF RETURN (IRR)

PROJECT A:
8%

PROJECT B:
3%

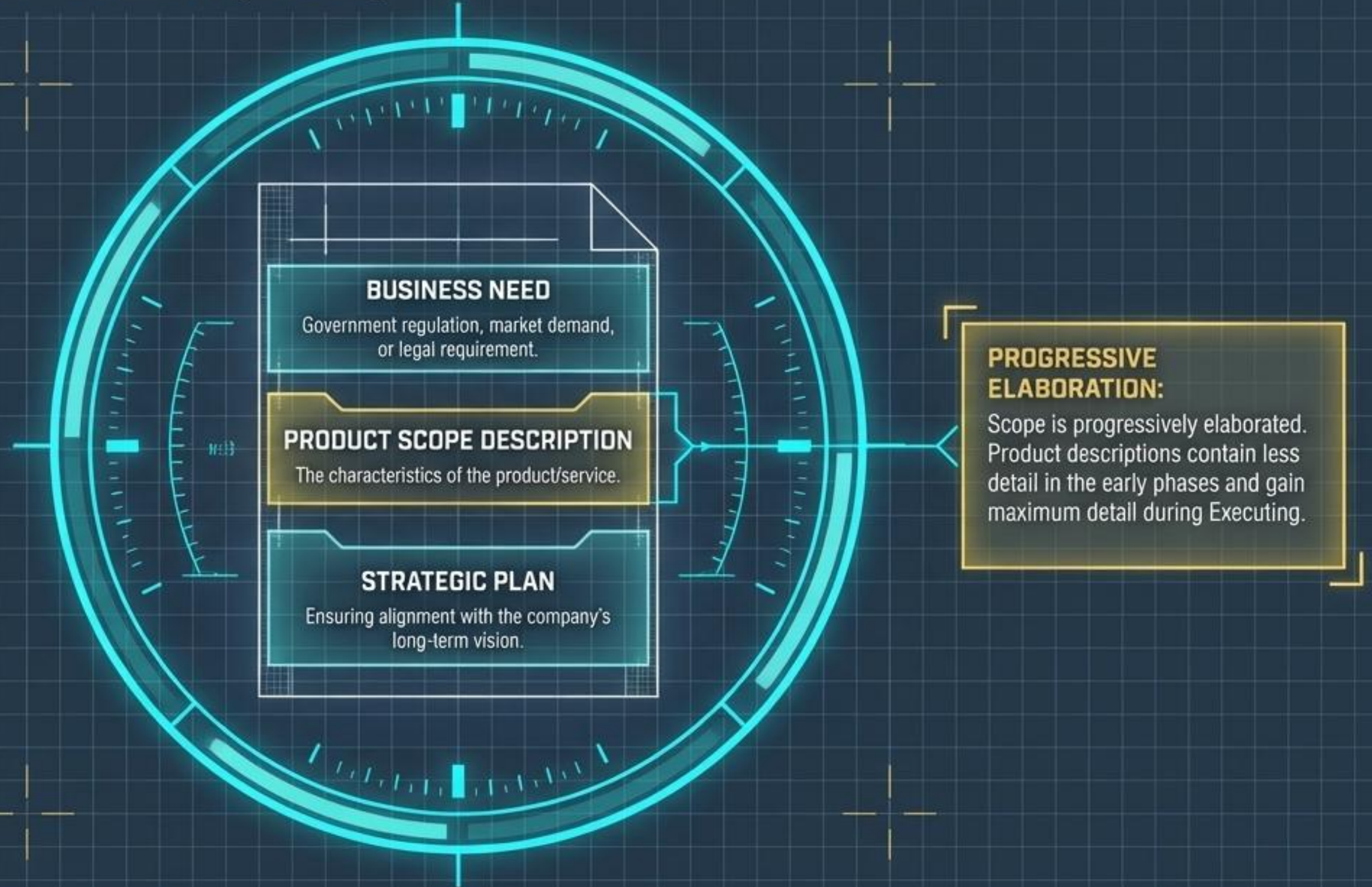
- **Rule:** IRR is the discount rate when NPV equals 0.
- **Nuance:** Always choose the project with the highest IRR.

BUILDING THE BUSINESS CASE



BOUNDARY WARNING: The Business Case analysis, funding discussions, and approval all happen **OUTSIDE** the boundaries of the actual project. The project team is typically not involved yet.

THE STATEMENT OF WORK (SOW)



THE PROJECT CHARTER



CORE FUNCTION OF THE CHARTER:

- It is the written acknowledgment that the project officially exists.
- The Critical Authority Rule: The Charter officially names the Project Manager and grants them the organizational authority to commit resources. The project does not begin until this is signed.

SYNTHESIS: THE SCOPE GENESIS



Project Scope is never created in a vacuum. It is progressively elaborated and rigorously justified before the first resource is ever assigned.

FINAL TAKEAWAYS

THE SELECTION BOUNDARY

Formal project selection is technically outside the Project Manager's scope (handled by sponsors/committees), but PMs must understand the math to assist.



CASH IS KING

The Time Value of Money dictates decision-making. Always favor projects with $NPV > 0$ and the highest Internal Rate of Return (IRR).



THE STARTING LINE

The Project Charter is the ultimate output of Initiation. It bridges business strategy with project execution and officially empowers the PM.

